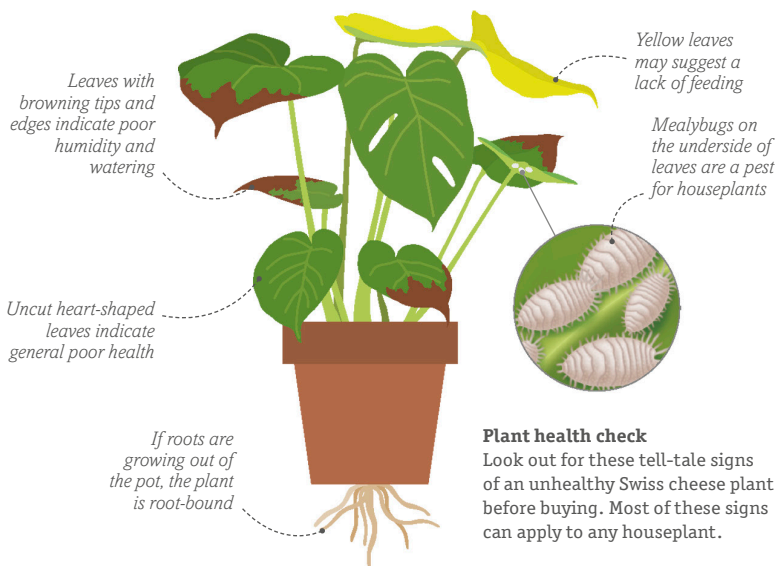




the plant a thorough check over for the three Ds—are the branches or leaves dead, diseased, or damaged?

Buy in bud

It's always best to buy flowering plants when they are mostly in bud. That way, they will be ready to burst into flower as soon as you get them home.

Check the display

Ensure that the pot has drainage holes so that excess water can drain away; if it doesn't, it is important to repot it to prevent the roots sitting in water. For the same reason, check that the plant has not been left sitting in a tray of water while on display. (*See right.*)

Ask questions

Talk to the plant experts in the store and ask for advice. It's the best way to get to know your new plant and how to care for it.

“Check the plant for the **three Ds**—is it dead, diseased, or damaged?”

